

Pharmacy Management System - Project Scheduling

Practical 1: Requirement Gathering for Pharmacy Management Software Project

Aim: To gather and document requirements for developing a Pharmacy Management System to ensure a comprehensive understanding of system needs.

Introduction: Requirement gathering is a crucial initial phase in software development where the needs and expectations of stakeholders are identified and documented. For a Pharmacy Management System (PMS), understanding requirements ensures the final product effectively automates processes like inventory management, sales tracking, billing, and customer record management.

Objective:

- To identify and document functional and non-functional requirements.
- To understand stakeholder needs and expectations.
- To ensure clarity and completeness of requirements.

Theory: Requirement gathering is the process of collecting information about the desired features and functionalities of a software system. It involves engaging with stakeholders, analyzing current processes, and identifying pain points and opportunities for automation.

Key steps in requirement gathering include:

1. Stakeholder Identification:

- Identify key stakeholders such as pharmacists, sales staff, inventory managers, and customers.
- Engage with stakeholders to understand their roles and needs.

2. Methods of Requirement Gathering:

- **Interviews:** Conduct structured interviews with stakeholders.
- **Surveys and Questionnaires:** Collect feedback through surveys.
- **Workshops and Brainstorming:** Collaborate with teams to identify features.
- **Observation:** Observe current pharmacy processes to identify inefficiencies.

3. Types of Requirements:

- **Functional Requirements:** Features like inventory tracking, sales processing, billing, and reporting.
- **Non-Functional Requirements:** Performance, scalability, security, and usability.

4. Documentation:

- Record requirements in detail, ensuring clarity and avoiding ambiguity.
- Use requirement specification documents for formalizing needs.

5. Validation:

- Review requirements with stakeholders.
- Address conflicts and prioritize features.

Conclusion: Requirement gathering is foundational to the success of the Pharmacy Management System project. By thoroughly understanding and documenting the needs of stakeholders, developers can create a system that aligns with business objectives and improves pharmacy operations.